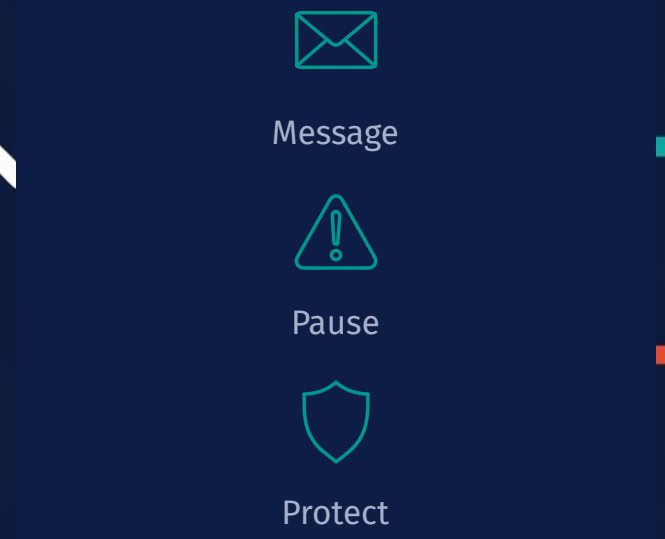
CODEALPHA CYBERSECURITY INTERNSHIP

Phishing Awareness Training

Recognize. Verify. Protect.

Project: Phishing Awareness Training

Presented by: Kavi · Domain: Cybersecurity



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THE CORE IDEA

Understanding Phishing

Phishing is a social engineering attack in which an attacker impersonates a trusted person or organization to trigger an unsafe action.

Key takeaway: Phishing targets human trust as well as technical weaknesses.

Flow: Attacker → Deceptive Message → Victim Interaction → Potential Compromise



Attacker



Deceptive message



Victim interaction



Potential compromise



Steal login credentials



Obtain sensitive or financial information



Install malware



Gain unauthorized access

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ANATOMY OF THE ATTACK

Anatomy of a Phishing Attack

The attacker prepares the story, creates pressure, and waits for one unsafe action.

01

Preparation

Impersonate a trusted organization or person.

02

Delivery

Send a deceptive email, SMS, message, or call.

03

Manipulation

Create urgency, fear, curiosity, or trust.

04

Victim action

Click, open, or share information.

05

Possible impact

Credentials, malware, or unauthorized access.

FICTIONAL EXAMPLE

“Your account requires verification. Please review this unexpected request through the official website.”

Key takeaway: Recognizing manipulation before action can prevent an attack.

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CHANNELS AND TACTICS

Know the Different Types

Phishing can arrive through multiple channels, not just email.



Email phishing

Deceptive email asks for a click or disclosure.

Example: a fake campus notice.



Spear phishing

Targeted message tailored to one person or organization.

Example: a fake manager request.



Smishing

Phishing through SMS or text.

Example: a fake delivery update.



Vishing

Voice-based deception through a call.

Example: a fake bank representative.



Clone phishing

Copied message modified with a malicious link or attachment.

Example: a fake resend of a real notice.

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PAUSE BEFORE YOU RESPOND

Spot the Red Flags

FICTIONAL SAMPLE EMAIL

SUBJECT

URGENT — Your Student Account May Be Suspended

Dear Student, unusual activity has been detected. Take immediate action to verify your account.

1

Urgency and pressure

Threats push the recipient to act quickly.

2

Unverified sender

Sender address may be suspicious or unexpected.

3

Unexpected verification request

Sensitive information is requested without context.

4

Misleading destination

Link requires independent verification.

5

Unexpected attachment

Open only after confirming the sender and reason.

6

Unusual payment request

A normal procedure m
bypassed.

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WEBSITE VERIFICATION

Check Before You Trust a Website

A secure connection is not automatically a trustworthy website.

MISLEADING DOMAIN · FICTIONAL

campus-secure-verify.example

Misspellings or misleading variations can imitate an organization.

HYPOTHETICAL VERIFIED DOMAIN · FICTIONAL

official-campus.example

Confirm the site belongs to the organization it claims to represent.

01

Inspect the domain.

02

Navigate independently.

03

Be cautious with passwords, payment details, or codes.

04

Use a password manager and multifactor authentication where available.

HTTPS encrypts the connection, but HTTPS alone does not prove a website is legitimate.

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The Psychology Behind Phishing



Fear

Account suspension or financial loss



Urgency

An artificial deadline



Trust

Impersonation of a teacher, bank, employer, or service



Curiosity

An unexpected document or message

Manipulation

Emotional Trigger → Pressure to Act → Reduced Verification → Increased Risk

Defense

STOP THINK VERIFY REPORT

Example: a fictional message claims a student's college account will be disabled within ten minutes unless they verify.

Key takeaway: Attackers often try to make people act before they think.

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FICTIONAL EMAIL CREATED FOR CYBERSECURITY EDUCATION

Case Study: Can You Spot the Phishing Indicators?

SUBJECT: IMMEDIATE ACTION REQUIRED — VERIFY YOUR ACCOUNT

Dear User, We detected an issue with your account. Your access may be suspended unless you verify your account immediately. Please use the verification link provided in this message. Regards, Account Support Team

- Urgent language pressures the recipient
- The suspension threat creates fear
- The unexpected verification request needs independent confirmation
- The sender identity and link destination are not verified

Correct response: Do not click; check sender and context; contact the organization independently; visit the official website directly; report if appropriate.

Treat it as suspicious until verified, not conclusively malicious from wording alone.

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KNOWLEDGE CHECK

Test Your Phishing Awareness

1. Unexpected suspension message? A click now · B reply with password · C verify through an independently trusted channel · D forward to everyone.
2. Which HTTPS statement is correct? A every site is legitimate · B it encrypts the connection but does not prove trust · C it prevents every attack · D it guarantees a bank.
3. What is smishing? A phishing through SMS or text · B password storage · C monitoring tool · D software update.
4. Unexpected attachment? A open · B disable antivirus · C verify sender and reason first · D send credentials.
5. Password entered on a suspected site? A ignore · B change through the legitimate service and contact support · C share it · D click again.

ANSWER PANEL

Reveal the answers

C

Verify through an independently trusted channel.

B

HTTPS encrypts the connection but does not prove trust.

A

Smishing is phishing through SMS or text.

C

Verify the sender and reason first.

B

Change it through the legitimate service and contact support.

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Stay Alert. Stay Secure.

Cybersecurity starts with awareness. A moment of verification can prevent a costly mistake.

Verify unexpected messages independently

Inspect sender addresses and website domains

Avoid suspicious links and unexpected attachments

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Thank You

Use unique passwords, a password manager, and multifactor authentication

Keep software and devices updated

Report suspected phishing attempts

If credentials are disclosed, change them through the legitimate service and follow its incident-response guidance

STOP VERIFY PROTECT REPORT

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